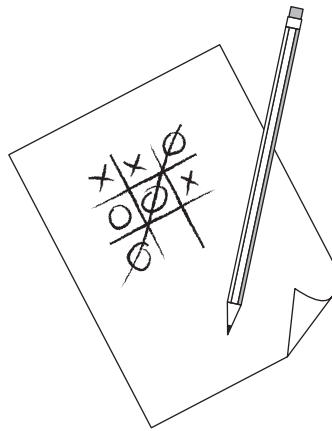


8. [Maximum mark: 5]

A class of students plays a tic-tac-toe competition among themselves. Each individual game in the competition involves only two students.



Every student in the class is to play every other student twice. However, Stephen left the class after he had played only seven games. All other games, not involving Stephen, were played.

By the end of the competition a total of 513 games had been played.

Determine the number of students that were originally in the class.

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